

— EDITION 01

ONE ACADEMY. SIX KIDS. A GLOBAL EMPIRE.

Manchester United '92–'99 wasn't luck. It was an operating model.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 06

"YOU CAN'T WIN ANYTHING WITH KIDS."

Alan Hansen, live on Match of the Day, August 1995. United had just trusted a core of academy graduates — Giggs, Scholes, Beckham, the Nevilles, Butt — with the first team. *They won the league that season.*

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| BUILD VS BUY.

The Class of '92 was a talent strategy, not sentiment. A homegrown core at near-zero acquisition cost anchored a side competing with clubs assembled in the transfer market. *Pipelines compound. Fees don't.*

0303 / 06

CULTURE WAS THE SUCCESSION PLAN.

Ferguson rebuilt three different squads around one standard. The dressing room enforced it before the manager had to. *Culture is what lets you replace players without replacing identity.*

0404 / 06

| THE FLYWHEEL.

Identity won trophies. Trophies built a global fanbase. The fanbase fed megastore and merchandising revenue. The plc turned that into capital, and the capital was reinvested in the squad. *By the late '90s, United had industrialised winning.*

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| 1999.

Premier League. FA Cup. Champions League.
The treble, completed in injury time in
Barcelona, by a squad built around the
academy core. *No English club had ever done
it.*

0606 / 06

| THE DYNASTY TEST.

Four questions from the '92 model: Do we build talent, or only buy it? Would our standards survive a change of personnel? Does our identity feed commercial value, or just cost money? And are the gains being reinvested, or extracted? *Save this slide.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

DYNASTIES ARE DESIGNED.

Chapter 2 covers the succession failure that ended it all. Full analysis in today's ARCHV Dispatch — link in the first comment.